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U.S. Department of Homeland Security
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
Texas Service Center
6820 Merrivale Loop
Mesquite, TX 75149-8802

REQUEST FOR EVIDENCE

Receipt Number	SRC2590174382
Notice Date	March 12, 2026
Case Type	I-129, Petition for a Nonimmigrant Worker
Requested Classification	O-1A — Alien of Extraordinary Ability in the Sciences
Petitioner	Voltaris Grid Dynamics, Inc.
Beneficiary	FERREIRA-DUARTE, Anselm
Beneficiary ID Number	A-214 776 903
Requested Validity	June 1, 2026 to May 31, 2029
Received Date	November 4, 2025
Notice Type	Request for Evidence
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MELOY & TRANT LLP
ATTN: Corinne Ashby-Meloy, Esq.
22 Fenwick Street, Suite 1410
Denver, CO 80209

RESPOND BY: JUNE 10, 2026

WHY WE ARE WRITING TO YOU

On November 4, 2025, you filed Form I-129, Petition for a Nonimmigrant Worker, with a request that the beneficiary be classified as an alien of extraordinary ability in the sciences under section 101(a)(15)(O)(i) of the Immigration and Nationality Act.

We have reviewed the petition and the initial evidence. The evidence submitted is not sufficient for us to make a decision on your petition. This notice tells you what additional evidence we need. Please read the entire notice carefully before you respond.

To establish eligibility, the petitioner must show that the beneficiary has extraordinary ability in the sciences, demonstrated by sustained national or international acclaim, and that the beneficiary is coming temporarily to the United States to continue work in the area of extraordinary ability. See 8 CFR 214.2(o)(3)(ii).

Extraordinary ability in the field of science means a level of expertise indicating that the person is one of the small percentage who has risen to the very top of the field of endeavor. Evidence may consist of a major, internationally recognized award, or at least three of the forms of evidence listed at 8 CFR 214.2(o)(3)(iii)(B)(1) through (8). Meeting the plain language of three criteria is not by itself sufficient; we then consider all of the evidence together to determine whether the beneficiary is among the small percentage at the very top of the field and has sustained national or international acclaim.

The petitioner claimed the following criteria in the petition support letter dated October 27, 2025: nationally or internationally recognized prizes or awards; original scientific contributions of major significance; authorship of scholarly articles; participation as a judge of the work of others; and a high salary or other remuneration.

The items below identify what was submitted, why it is not sufficient, and what you may submit in response. The items are not in order of importance. You must respond to every item.

ITEM 1 — CONSULTATION (ADVISORY OPINION) FROM A PEER GROUP

Evidence submitted: The record contains the petition support letter and its exhibit index at Exhibits A through F. No written advisory opinion from a peer group, labor organization, or person or organization with expertise in the beneficiary's field appears anywhere in the record, and none is listed on the exhibit index.

Why we need more evidence: A petition for O-1 classification must be accompanied by a written consultation from a peer group, labor organization, or a person designated by the group with expertise in the beneficiary's area of ability. See 8 CFR 214.2(o)(5)(i). This is a separate statutory requirement and is not satisfied by expert opinion letters obtained by the petitioner to support the evidentiary criteria. We cannot approve this petition without it.

Evidence you should submit (submit all that apply):

- A written advisory opinion from a peer group or a labor organization having expertise in the beneficiary's specific field of endeavor. The opinion must describe the beneficiary's ability and achievements in the field, the nature of the duties to be performed, and whether the position requires a person of extraordinary ability.
- The opinion must be on the letterhead of the issuing organization, be dated, and be signed by a person authorized to issue it.
- If you contend that no appropriate peer group or labor organization exists for this field, a detailed statement explaining what search was undertaken, whom you contacted, and on what dates, together with any written responses received.

ITEM 2 — CERTIFIED ENGLISH TRANSLATIONS OF FOREIGN LANGUAGE DOCUMENTS

Evidence submitted: Exhibit C-4 is described on the exhibit index as the original citation issued with the Halvorsen Medal in Energy Storage Engineering. The petition support letter states that this citation is in the Portuguese language. Exhibit C-4 is accompanied by an English summary prepared by counsel.

Why we need more evidence: Any document containing foreign language submitted to USCIS must be accompanied by a full English language translation which the translator has certified as complete and accurate, and by the translator's certification that he or she is competent to translate from the foreign language into English. See 8 CFR 103.2(b)(3). A summary or paraphrase prepared by the petitioner or by counsel is not a certified translation, and an uncertified document has no evidentiary weight. The record contains no translator certification for any document.

Evidence you should submit:

- A complete, word-for-word English translation of every foreign language document in the record, including Exhibit C-4.
- For each translation, a signed and dated certification by the translator stating that the translation is complete and accurate and that the translator is competent to translate from Portuguese into English.
- A legible copy of the foreign language original alongside each translation.

ITEM 3 — RECEIPT OF NATIONALLY OR INTERNATIONALLY RECOGNIZED PRIZES OR AWARDS FOR EXCELLENCE IN THE FIELD, 8 CFR 214.2(O)(3)(III)(B)(1)

Evidence submitted: Exhibit C, described as an award evidence packet for the Halvorsen Medal in Energy Storage Engineering conferred by the Continental Society for Energy Storage Engineering in 2024, including the governing bylaws for the award, the selection procedure, the composition of the selection panel, the number of nominations considered, a list of prior recipients, and press coverage of the conferral.

Why we need more evidence: The record establishes that the award was conferred. However, the weight to be given to an award depends on the recognition it commands within the field as a whole rather than within the conferring organization alone. Please supplement the record so that we can evaluate the national or international standing of this award, including the geographic scope from which candidates are drawn.

Evidence you should submit (submit all that apply):

- Documentation of the criteria used to select recipients, and evidence that those criteria are based on excellence in the field.
- Evidence of the national or international significance of the award, such as media coverage in publications circulated beyond the conferring organization's own membership.
- Evidence identifying the field, geographic area, and pool from which candidates are drawn, and the number of candidates considered in the relevant cycle.
- Evidence of the reputation and standing of the granting organization, and of the qualifications of the individuals who selected the recipient.
- Evidence concerning previous recipients of the same award and their standing in the field.

ITEM 4 — ORIGINAL SCIENTIFIC CONTRIBUTIONS OF MAJOR SIGNIFICANCE IN THE FIELD, 8 CFR 214.2(O)(3)(III)(B)(5)

Evidence submitted: Two opinion letters, at Exhibits B-1 and B-2, describing the beneficiary's development of Drift-Indexed Impedance Spectroscopy and the associated HeliosGuard detection model; a publication and citation summary at Exhibit D; and statements in the petition support letter that the method has been adopted outside the petitioner's own organization.

Why we need more evidence: Opinion letters that describe research as important, without identifying how the work has been implemented, relied upon, or built upon by others in the field, are of limited probative value. The record should show not merely that the contributions are original, but that they have already been recognized as being of major significance to the field beyond the beneficiary's own employers and co-authors.

Evidence you should submit (submit all that apply):

- Evidence that the beneficiary's work has been implemented, licensed, commercialized, or otherwise put into use by entities independent of the beneficiary and the petitioner, with documentation from those entities describing the scope and result of that use.
- Evidence that the beneficiary's methods have been incorporated into an industry standard, code, specification, or regulatory guidance, with the relevant portion of the document identified.
- Documentation showing how others in the field have relied upon or extended the work, such as citation analysis with context.
- Detailed letters from experts in the field who are not the beneficiary's employers, supervisors, co-authors, or business partners, explaining the specific significance of the contributions rather than restating the beneficiary's biography.

ITEM 5 — AUTHORSHIP OF SCHOLARLY ARTICLES IN THE FIELD, IN PROFESSIONAL JOURNALS OR OTHER MAJOR MEDIA, 8 CFR 214.2(O)(3)(III)(B)(6)

Evidence submitted: Exhibit D, a publication and citation summary listing peer-reviewed

journal articles and conference papers authored or co-authored by the beneficiary, together with information on the publishing venues.

Why we need more evidence: We must be able to confirm that the articles are scholarly, that the beneficiary is a named author, and that the venues are professional journals or other major media in the field. Please supplement the record with venue-level information sufficient for that determination.

Evidence you should submit (submit all that apply):

- A list of each article with its full title, all named authors in the order printed, the publication name, the volume and issue, the page range, and the publication date.
- Evidence of the intended audience, editorial standards, and peer review process of each publication.
- Evidence of each publication's circulation, subscriber base, or indexing in recognized databases of the field.

ITEM 6 — PARTICIPATION AS A JUDGE OF THE WORK OF OTHERS IN THE SAME OR AN ALLIED FIELD, 8 CFR 214.2(O)(3)(III)(B)(4)

Evidence submitted: The petition support letter states that the beneficiary has served as a peer reviewer for two scholarly journals and as a member of a national grant review panel. Exhibit D contains a reviewer acknowledgement for one journal.

Why we need more evidence: A statement in a support letter that the beneficiary was invited to judge the work of others does not establish that the judging actually occurred. This criterion requires evidence of actual participation. The record does not contain invitations, assignment records, completion confirmations, or dates for the second journal or for the grant review panel.

Evidence you should submit, for each judging activity claimed:

- The written invitation or appointment, showing the date and the body that issued it.
- Evidence that the beneficiary accepted and completed the assignment, such as a completion confirmation, a reviewer report, or an acknowledgement identifying the manuscripts or applications reviewed.
- The number of manuscripts, applications, or submissions reviewed and the dates on which the reviews were performed.
- Evidence describing the selection process for reviewers or panelists and the standing of the journal, conference, or funding body.

ITEM 7 — EVIDENCE THAT THE BENEFICIARY HAS COMMANDED A HIGH SALARY OR OTHER SIGNIFICANTLY HIGH REMUNERATION, 8 CFR 214.2(O)(3)(III)(B)(8)

Evidence submitted: Exhibit F, an executed employment agreement between the petitioner and the

beneficiary stating an annual base salary, a signing bonus, and an equity grant.

Why we need more evidence: The criterion is comparative. Documentation of what the beneficiary will be paid does not, by itself, establish that the amount is high in relation to what others in the field receive. The record contains no wage data, survey, or other comparison against which the offered compensation can be measured, and no statement of the geographic area used for comparison.

Evidence you should submit (submit all that apply):

- Reliable wage data for the beneficiary's occupation in the intended area of employment, such as Bureau of Labor Statistics Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics data, a published industry compensation survey, or comparable published sources, with the source and date shown.
- An explanation identifying the occupational classification and geographic area used, and why they are the appropriate comparison for this position.
- Evidence of the beneficiary's actual past earnings, such as pay statements, tax documents, or employer letters stating amounts actually paid.
- If equity or other non-salary remuneration is relied upon, documentation of its value and the basis on which that value was determined.

ITEM 8 — TERMS, DATES, AND DUTIES OF THE OFFERED EMPLOYMENT

Evidence submitted: Exhibit F, an executed employment agreement identifying the position, duties, work location, start and end dates, and compensation.

Why we need more evidence: Please confirm that the agreement covers the entire validity period requested on Form I-129, and provide any amendment or addendum executed after the date of the agreement.

Evidence you should submit:

- A copy of any amendment, addendum, or extension to the employment agreement.
- A statement identifying every work location at which the beneficiary will perform services during the requested validity period.

HOW TO RESPOND

Submit all of the requested evidence together, at one time. We will make a decision on the record as it stands when we receive your response or when the response period expires, whichever comes first. Partial responses may result in denial.

Place the original of this notice on top of your response so that our mail room can match your evidence to the correct file. Responses submitted without this notice may be delayed or may not

be
matched to your petition.

Mail your response to:

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
Texas Service Center
ATTN: O Nonimmigrant Unit
6820 Merrivale Loop
Mesquite, TX 75149-8802

Your response must be received on or before JUNE 10, 2026. We cannot grant an extension of this deadline. If we do not receive a response by that date, we will make a decision based on the evidence already in the record, which may result in denial of the petition.

Do not submit original documents unless we specifically ask for them. Submit legible photocopies.
Documents you submit will not be returned to you.

If any of the evidence you submit is found to be false or fraudulent, the petition will be denied and the matter may be referred for investigation.

This notice does not constitute a decision on your petition and does not grant any immigration benefit or status.

Officer ID: TSC-0472 · Team 3 · Do not reply to this notice by electronic mail.

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